CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

EV CHARGING TECHNICIAN IN THE AI ERA

Every charger that blinks red is a service call — and thousands more get installed every month.

★ TL;DR — Around $75K a year for techs who can install and service charging equipment, reachable in 6–12 months with electrical training and EV-specific certification. The catch: electrical rules are state law — the licensed work must be done under the right license, yours or your employer's. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

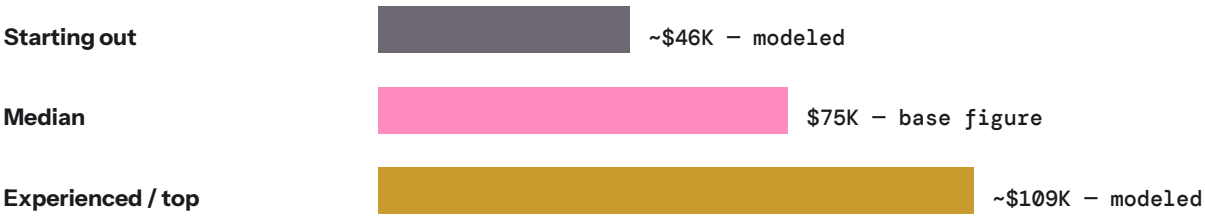
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 6-12 months · AI RISK LOW · CERTIFICATE

- Charging networks live or die on uptime — broken chargers are the industry's public embarrassment and its service goldmine.
- The trade sits between electrician and IT tech: power, networking and software in one cabinet.
- Employers and manufacturers certify techs on their equipment, so trained hands get snapped up.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for EV Charging Technician is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A EV CHARGING TECHNICIAN ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Install and commission EV chargers at homes, fleets, workplaces and public sites
- ✓ Diagnose dead chargers: power faults, network drops, payment and software failures
- ✓ Swap components, update firmware and document service in the network's system
- ✓ Respond to uptime targets — the network grades every repair

Think: an electrician for gas stations that run on apps — half the failures are power, half are Wi-Fi with consequences.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI monitors the networks, predicts charger failures and dispatches techs with the likely part already identified. Remote resets fix a share of faults without a truck roll.	The rest needs hands: water in a conduit, a vandalized cable, a breaker that trips only under load in August. Physical infrastructure fails physically — diagnosis on site stays human work.

⚠ **Electrical work is regulated: in many states, installations must be performed or supervised by a licensed electrician. Know exactly which side of that line your role sits on before you touch a panel — employers structure this differently.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ New trade, short line: demand outruns trained supply ✓ Outdoor, varied sites, no two faults alike ✓ A front-row seat in the EV transition with trade-grade pay	✗ Weather and roadside work are part of the route ✗ Uptime SLAs mean some days are all emergencies ✗ Networks consolidate and contracts shift — employers change

Good fit? An electrical-minded troubleshooter who likes field service, learns software quickly and respects licensing rules instead of resenting them.
Bad fit? You want a desk, or you think permits and electrical code are optional paperwork.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — ELECTRICAL FIRST	DOOR B — SERVICE TECH WITH A NETWORK

The strongest route: build real electrical skill — apprenticeship hours or electrical training — then add EV charging certification and manufacturer training. Licensed-track techs can legally do the whole job and get paid like it.	Charging networks and service companies hire field techs for maintenance and repair under their master licenses: commissioning checks, module swaps, connectivity fixes. A real entry — with the license boundary managed by the employer.

Smart move: Learn the networking half as seriously as the power half. The tech who fixes both the breaker fault and the network configuration in one visit is the one networks fight to keep.
Where you land after: Senior field tech, commissioning lead, or your own EV-infrastructure service company contracting to networks and fleets.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
MAP THE	BUILD ELECTRICAL	EARN EV-SPECIFIC	LEARN THE	GET FIELD	SPECIALIZE IN

STEP 1 — Map the license line in your state

FREE · 1 WEEK

- Research what electrical work requires a license in your state and how charger installation is treated.
- Decide your lane with open eyes: licensed track, or employed service tech under a company's license.

STEP 2 — Build electrical fundamentals

$1,000-10,000 · 3-9 MONTHS

- Electrical training through a trade school, apprenticeship entry, or employer program: circuits, panels, conduit, code basics.
- Charger work is load-calculation work — get fluent in the math early.

STEP 3 — Earn EV-specific certification

$300-1,500 · 2-6 WEEKS

- Complete a recognized EV infrastructure training and certification program for technicians.
- Add manufacturer training for the charger brands your region installs most.

STEP 4 — Learn the network stack

FREE–$300 · 1 MONTH

- Cellular and Ethernet connectivity, charger management platforms, payment systems, firmware updates.
- Set up a home lab habit: break and fix configurations on paper before the field teaches you harder.

STEP 5 — Get field hours

PAID · MONTHS 4–9

- Apply to charging networks, electrical contractors with EV divisions and fleet depots.
- Ride along on service calls if anyone lets you — fault patterns are the real curriculum.

STEP 6 — Specialize in uptime

PAID · YEAR 1

- Become the tech networks call for repeat-failure sites: root-cause, documented, fixed once.
- Track your first-time-fix rate — it is the number your whole career will be graded on.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: research your state's electrical licensing line for charger work and write down your lane.
- □ Days 1–30: start electrical training or the apprenticeship application; enroll in EV infrastructure coursework.
- □ Days 31–60: fundamentals building — circuits, panels, load math — plus charger platform familiarization.
- □ Days 61–90: EV certification completed or scheduled; first field-role applications out to networks and contractors.
- □ Day 90: credentialed and in the hiring pipeline of the fastest-growing corner of the electrical trade.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **UPTIME IS THE PRODUCT.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.